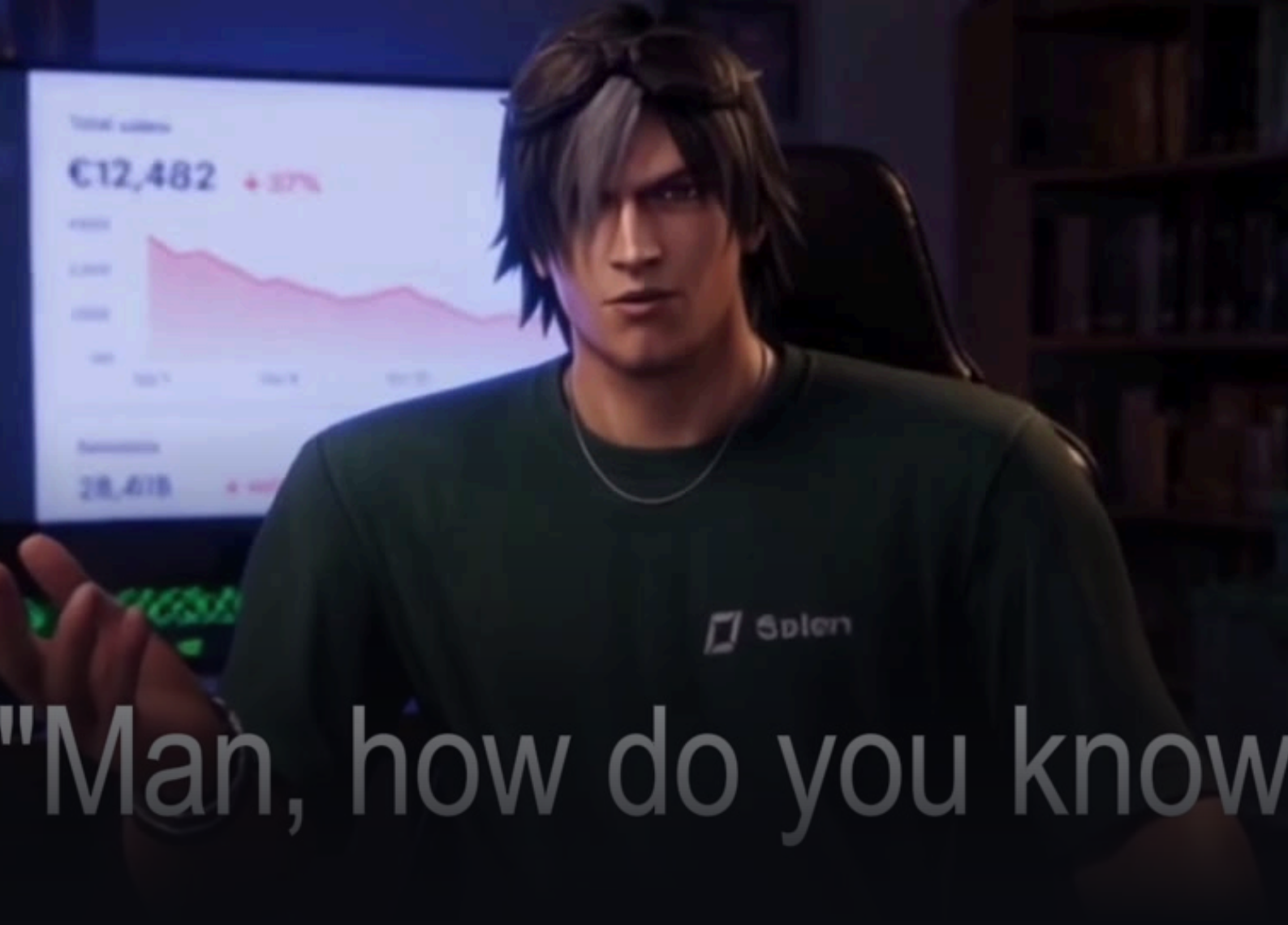


THE PLAYBOOK

Cutscene Ads

How to make a PS2-style CGI character ad with AI, from blank page to posted video. One recurring character, about 20 seconds, and roughly $3 of generation on our example.

Script · Character · Sets · Silent shots · Voice · Lip sync · Edit · Measure

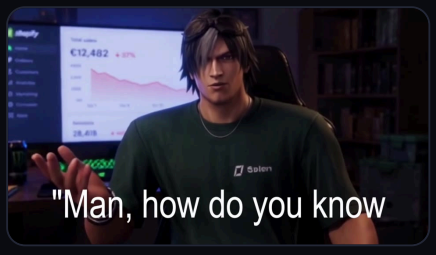
01 · WHAT YOU WILL MAKE

A 20 second ad that looks like a 2005 game cutscene

A recurring character talks straight to your audience, in a set that tells them instantly who the ad is for. Every frame below comes from the example video built with this playbook: a 20 second ad for a Shopify tool, made with sume.com and CapCut.



0s · hook, wide set



3s · he talks to camera



5s · the set tells the story



7s · pain line, close up



15s · punchline



17s · end card + CTA

The specs of the example

Length	20 seconds: about 17 s of character, then the end card
Tools	sume.com (images, Wan 3.0 video, lip sync), CapCut (edit, captions)
Cost	About $3 of generation for the finished video, retries included
Skills needed	None technical. Copy the prompts, follow the steps.

Why this format, and how the pipeline works

Most short ads look like other ads. A pre-rendered cutscene from a PS2 era game does not: waxy skin, chunky hair, soft light, a little blur. It reads as nostalgia and as a joke at the same time, and a character who speaks your customer's inner monologue makes them feel seen.

> **Be honest with yourself:** this is a creative bet, not a guaranteed result. The format stops the scroll for some audiences and not for others. Section 08 shows how to measure it on your own account before you scale it.

The 8 steps

01
Script
A 5 beat script, about 60 words, with pauses between sentences.

02
Character
One original character with 3 traits people remember.

03
Sets
3 to 5 images of the same location, in the same style.

04
Voice
Record or generate the voice first. Everything is timed on it.

05
Silent shots
Generate the video with the mouth closed and no audio.

06
Lip sync
Sync the mouth to your voice track, only on face shots.

07
Edit
Captions, end card, loudness, 9:16 export.

08
Measure
Track 4 numbers, change one thing per video.

The one rule that saves you money

Do not ask the video model to act, talk and sing at once. Generate a **silent** character with the **mouth closed**, then add the voice with lip sync. Our first attempts asked the model to keep a reference audio and lip sync it in one pass: the model kept the wrong audio, cut in the middle of sentences, and every retry cost a full generation.

Write a 5 beat script your audience recognizes

About 60 words for 20 seconds. Write short sentences: the edit only cuts in the silences between sentences, never in the middle of one.

BEAT	TIME	JOB	EXAMPLE LINE
Hook	0 to 6 s	Name the audience and quote their question	Shopifiers will say: "Man, how do you know I do Shopify for a living?"
Wink	6 to 9 s	A beat of attitude	Haha, like I don't know, bro.
Mirror	9 to 21 s	Three habits or pains they will recognize	You just spend all your time staring at your stats, changing your product page with absolutely no clue, and wondering: "Why is my conversion rate so low?"
Punchline	21 to 25 s	One line people repeat	You met me at a very optimized time in my life.
CTA	last 4 s	What to do now, over the end card	Get your free product page audit at withsolen.com

Template

```
[AUDIENCE] will say: "Man, how do you know I [THEIR JOB OR HOBBY]?"

Haha, like I don't know, bro.

You just [HABIT 1], [HABIT 2], and wondering: "[THE QUESTION THEY ASK THEMSELVES]?"

[ONE MEMORABLE PUNCHLINE ABOUT YOUR PRODUCT].

[CTA: WHAT THEY GET] at [YOUR SITE]
```

Do

- Habits that are specific and a bit embarrassing.
- Read it aloud with a timer. Over 22 s of voice? Cut a line.
- Write the URL as "yoursite dot com" for the voice.

Avoid

- Feature lists. The character is not a salesman.
- Promises you cannot prove ("double your sales").
- Lines quoted from someone else's ad.

One original character, one location

Give the character exactly **3 identifiers** that survive every shot. In the example: jet black hair with one grey streak over the right eye, a dark fir green t-shirt with a small white logo, a silver wallet chain. Repeat these words, identical, in every prompt.

```
Character reference image. An original character, a man in his late 20s: [HAIR: color, cut, one distinctive streak or detail], [TOP: color + your small logo on the chest], [ONE ACCESSORY: chain, bracelets, glasses]. Neutral expression, mouth closed, standing, full body and face visible, plain background. Pre-rendered CGI cutscene from a 2005 PlayStation 2 game: low polygon model with visible angular edges, simple low resolution textures, smooth waxy plastic skin with no pores, hair made of a few thick glossy chunks, soft flat lighting, slightly washed out colors. Not photorealistic.
```

Then generate 3 to 5 images of **one** location that says who the ad is for. The example used a gamer bedroom: a monitor with a falling sales chart, stacked shipping boxes, a green neon sign. Same room, different angles.

```
Empty [LOCATION] at night, no people. [3 OBJECTS THAT TELL WHO IT IS FOR]. [ANGLE: wide shot of the room / close view of the desk and monitor / corner with the shelf and neon]. [LIGHT: blue screen light, green neon]. Same rendering style: pre-rendered CGI cutscene from a 2005 PlayStation 2 game, low polygon, simple textures, soft flat lighting, washed out colors, mild blur. 4:3.
```

> **Legal, read this once.** A visual style is free to use. Characters, faces and voices are not. Do not recreate a character from a game, film or another brand's ads, do not put a real person's face on him, and do not clone a voice you have no rights to. Use only your own logo. Original characters are also safer for the long run: you own them.

Lock the voice first, then generate a silent actor

1. **Voice track**

   Generate the voice with a text to speech voice you have the rights to, or record it yourself. Leave short silences between sentences. Note the start time of each sentence: your shots will be timed on them.

2. **Settings in sume.com, model Wan 3.0**

   References only: the character image plus your set images. **Sound: Off.** Duration 15 s. No reference video, no start or end frame (see section 06).

3. **Prompt**

   One continuous take, close framing for lip sync, mouth closed. Replace the brackets.

```
One single continuous shot, no cuts at all. The camera moves smoothly from one position to the next, like a slow handheld camera following him in one take.
Framing for lip sync: only close ups and medium close ups. His face always faces the camera or a slight three quarter angle, fully visible, never hidden by his hands, hair or objects. No wide shots, no shots from behind.
The only character is the man from the character reference image, exactly the same during the whole video: [3 IDENTIFIERS, word for word]. He is alone.
Setting: the [LOCATION] shown in the set reference images. [LIGHT] on him.
Rendering style: exactly like the set reference images, a pre-rendered CGI cutscene from a 2005 PlayStation 2 game. Low polygon models with visible angular edges, simple low resolution textures, smooth waxy plastic skin, hair in a few thick glossy chunks, soft flat lighting, washed out colors, 480p look. Not photorealistic, not a modern game.
He does not speak. Mouth closed and relaxed during the whole video. No sound.
0-5s: [ACTION FOR THE HOOK], slow push-in to a close up.
5-9s: without cutting, [ACTION FOR THE MIRROR].
9-12s: without cutting, [REACTION, e.g. tired deadpan look into the camera].
12-15s: without cutting, he looks straight at the camera and points at it, confident half smile.
No subtitles, no text on screen except the logo.
```

06 · WHAT WENT WRONG, SO IT DOES NOT HAPPEN TO YOU

Errors we hit and how to fix them

Each line below cost us at least one generation. Read it before your first try.

PROBLEM	FIX
"input_video_duration + duration exceeds 30s limit"	The reference video counts toward the limit. Remove it. You do not need it for a silent actor.
"Use either a start / end frame or reference media, not both"	Pick one. References only is the setup that worked in our runs.
Generation failed with many references	Remove any video from the references, then drop to the character plus 2 sets.
The model keeps the audio of the reference video	Never feed it a video with a voice you do not want. Sound Off, voice added later.
Hard cuts between shots, sometimes mid sentence	Ask for "one single continuous shot, no cuts", or generate one clip per shot and join them in the edit.
Looks like a modern game, too realistic	Name the defects you want: low polygon, angular edges, low resolution textures, hair in thick chunks, washed out colors, 480p.
Hair or logo changes between shots	Repeat the 3 identifiers word for word. "The blue tint on his hair is only the light" stops colored lighting from changing the hair.
Lip sync looks wrong	The face was too small or turned away. Ask for close ups, face to camera, mouth visible, no hands in front.
Video is 16:9 or 4:3 on a vertical app	Choose the ratio before you generate, or reframe in the edit (section 07).

Sync the mouth, then finish in CapCut

1. **Lip sync**

   In the Lipsync tab of sume.com, give the silent video and your voice track. Sync only the parts where the face is visible. Shots of the screen or of his back stay as they are, the voice plays over them.

2. **Timeline in CapCut**

   Voice on top, synced video under it, music at the bottom. Cut only in the silences. Music well under the voice: you should understand every word on a phone speaker.

3. **Captions**

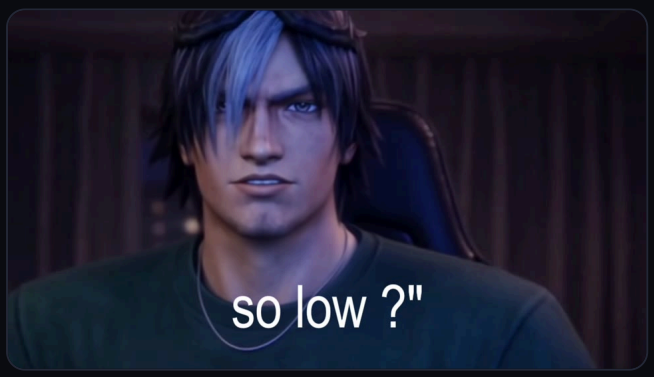
   Auto captions, 2 to 5 words at a time, big, centered in the lower third. Then **read every caption**: auto captions invent words. In our first export "so low ?" had a French space before the question mark, and "Haha, like I don't know, bro" became "ahahah like idk bro".

4. **End card, 3 to 4 seconds**

   Logo, one benefit, your URL in big type. The CTA line of the voice plays over it. Same aspect ratio as the video, or it shows black bars.

5. **Export**

   9:16, 1080 × 1920 for TikTok, Reels and Shorts. If your video is 16:9, place it full width in the middle with a blurred copy behind it. Loudness: aim for about -14 LUFS. Our first export was around -30 LUFS, much quieter than the videos around it.



Check every caption: "so low ?" should be "so low?"



End card: logo, benefit, URL

08 · STEP 8 · MEASURE AND COST

Know if it works before you make ten more

Post it, wait 48 hours, then write down four numbers from the platform analytics. Compare them with your average post, not with someone else's viral video.

METRIC	QUESTION IT ANSWERS
3 second hold rate	Does the opening frame stop the scroll?
Completion rate	Does the script hold attention to the end card?
Profile visits	Did the character make people curious about you?
Clicks or keyword comments	Did anyone act on the CTA?

Change one thing per video

Same character and set, new script: you learn which message works. Same script, new hook frame: you learn what stops the scroll. Change everything at once and you learn nothing.

Cost of the example

ITEM	WHAT WE SAW
Wan 3.0 video	A 20 s generation at 480p was listed at $1.00 on sume.com
Whole video	About $3 of generation, retries and lip sync included
CapCut	Edit, captions and end card

Prices change often. Check the price shown on the Generate button before each run.

09 · BEFORE YOU POST

The checklist

Script and rights

- [ ] 5 beats, 20 to 25 s of voice, read aloud with a timer
- [ ] No claim you cannot prove
- [ ] Original character, no real face, no cloned voice
- [ ] Music you have the right to use, or a platform sound
- [ ] Only your own logo on screen

Generation

- [ ] References only, no video, sound Off
- [ ] 3 identifiers repeated word for word
- [ ] One continuous shot, close framing
- [ ] Mouth closed in the prompt
- [ ] Aspect ratio chosen before generating

Edit

- [ ] Cuts only in the silences
- [ ] Every caption read and corrected
- [ ] Voice clear on a phone speaker
- [ ] End card 3 to 4 s, same ratio
- [ ] 1080 × 1920, about -14 LUFS

After posting

- [ ] 48 h later: hold rate, completion, profile visits, clicks
- [ ] Compared with your average post
- [ ] One change chosen for the next video
- [ ] Prompts saved with the result next to them

The short version

Write the voice, generate a silent and consistent actor, sync the mouth, cut in the silences, check the captions, measure. The character is the asset: every new video costs a few dollars because the character, the sets and the prompts already exist.